



"Don't just visit. Feel every place."

India's AI-Powered Hyperlocal Travel Companion

Mobile-First

Offline-Capable

India-Native

Built for the Moment of Arrival

2.3B+

Domestic trips · 2024

\$16.4B

Indian online travel · 2026E

900M+

Smartphone users · 2026E

71%

Dissatisfied with current tools

A Complete View of RIVA

01 The Problem

Why the in-trip experience is fundamentally broken

02 Market Opportunity

2B+ trips, \$16.4B market, structural tailwinds

03 Product Vision & Features

Core features, design pillars, audio guides, plan mode

04 User Personas

College groups, solos, couples, families, pilgrims

05 Competitive Landscape

Why RIVA owns the intersection no competitor holds

06 GTM & Brand Strategy

Positioning, messaging, acquisition channels

07 Pricing & Monetisation

Freemium model, ₹99/mo Pro, B2B revenue streams

08 Growth & Retention

Compounding loops, virality, community

09 Launch Playbook

Beta → public launch → national scale

10 Metrics, Roadmap & Risk

100K MAU target, KPIs, roadmap, risk mitigations

Travel in India is Broken at the Moment That Matters Most

Indians took 2.3B+ trips in 2024 — yet 'I'm here, what now?' still takes 20–40 minutes of app-hopping. Six failures recur every single trip.

01

Information Overload

5–10 min of stale blogs and contradictory reviews on every search. No real-time context.

02

Fragmented App Stack

67% use 3+ apps per trip. Maps + Zomato + TripAdvisor + YouTube + blogs — every time.

03

Poor Hyperlocal Discovery

City-level results with no depth at landmark or sub-locality level (<500m radius).

04

Weak In-Trip Personalisation

No tool plans around your 2 free hours, your budget, or your group's preferences.

05

No Real-Time Context

Crowd levels, opening hours, fees and weather are scattered — never together in one place.

06

Underserved Segments

Solo travellers lack a safety layer. Pilgrims have zero quality digital product. Offbeat is invisible.

THE TYPICAL BROKEN RESEARCH FLOW:

Google It (5–10 min on stale blogs) → TripAdvisor (Western-skewed, no planning) → Zomato (food only) → Wing It (no context, no confidence)

A \$16.4B Opportunity Riding India's Structural Travel Boom

2.3B+

Domestic trips
(India, 2024)

\$16.4B

Online travel market
(India, 2026E)

900M+

Smartphone users
(2026E)

12–14%

Leisure travel CAGR
(2024–28)

FIVE STRUCTURAL TAILWINDS IN 2026

01 Revenge Travel

Post-pandemic normalised higher travel frequency — even ₹800–2,000/day budget travellers take 3–4 trips/year.

02 UPI & Digital India

Payments, splitting, and booking are frictionless in ways they weren't 3 years ago.

03 Affordable 5G Rollout

Jio & Airtel expansion removes connectivity barriers in Tier 2 cities, expanding the addressable market.

04 Gen Z Travel Demand

YouTube-native travellers seek off-beat authentic experiences; deeply dissatisfied with TripAdvisor's western bias.

05 Pilgrimage Blue Ocean

300M+ annual pilgrimage trips — India's largest domestic segment with zero quality digital product serving it.

Why 2026 Is the Entry Window

Five forces converging in 2026 make this the rare window where the product, the infrastructure, and the audience all arrive together.

01

UPI Maturity

Payments, splits, bookings — frictionless in ways they weren't 3 years ago.

02

Smartphone Penetration

900M+ users by 2026E. Tier-2 and Tier-3 now mobile-first.

03

Affordable 5G Rollout

Jio & Airtel expansion removes connectivity barriers beyond metros.

04

Rise of Creator Economy

Micro-creators trusted over star ratings — RIVA's Real Talk fits perfectly.

05

Experiential Shift

Gen-Z seeks offbeat & authentic — deeply dissatisfied with TripAdvisor's western bias.

06

Domestic Travel Surge

Post-pandemic, domestic frequency normalised at 3–4 trips/yr across all segments.

Built for the Curious Traveller

To be the most trusted travel companion for every Indian traveller — the knowledgeable local friend who is always with you, wherever you go.

01 Context-First

Everything surfaces from where you are RIGHT NOW. No generic lists. If you're in Jaipur at 6PM, RIVA shows rooftop cafes and sunset viewpoints — not city-wide noise.

02 India-Native

Offline-first architecture. UPI-native payments. Hindi, Tamil, Bengali + 4 more regional languages. Built for Indian travel infrastructure, not Silicon Valley assumptions.

03 Instant Utility

Zero research required. Open the app, confirm location, get genuine value in under 30 seconds. Land in a new city → instant plan. No tutorial, no friction.

“

I'm here right now — what should I do next, how much will it cost, and where should I eat?

The one question every traveller actually has. RIVA answers it in under 30 seconds.

Six Pillars of Value — Built for Every Micro-Moment

CORE 01

Smart Itinerary Planner

Time-first input ('2 hrs free'). Sequenced plan with stops, food, walks, fees — delivered in under 3 seconds.

CORE 02

Hyperlocal Explore Mode

Three depth levels: 60-word Quick Reads to 1,200-word full cultural narratives. Move at your own pace.

CORE 03

AI Audio Guides

GPS-proximity triggered narration. Available in Hindi, English + 5 regional languages. Your personal tour guide.

CORE 04

Smart Food Finder

Budget & dietary filters (Jain/Vegan/Halal). Must-try dish badges. Local Pick vs. Tourist Pick labelling.

CORE 05

Vehicle Rental Locator

Verified bike, scooter, auto & cab options with real-time availability, RIVA user ratings and safety tips.

CORE 06

Offline Mode

Works without internet. Auto-triggered when RIVA detects low-signal zones. Maps, guides & saved recs available.

Explore Mode & AI Audio Guides

THREE LEVELS OF DISCOVERY

L1

60–90 words

Quick Read

One key fact, one compelling story, one must-see recommendation. Perfect for couples and professionals who want instant context.

L2

250–350 words

Depth

Rich history, architectural significance, cultural context, and local tips. For curious travellers who want to truly understand where they are.

L3

600–1,200 words

Full History

Complete narrative with legends, pilgrimage context, and deep cultural storytelling. For the traveller who wants to feel every place deeply.

AI AUDIO GUIDES

GPS-Triggered Narration

- ▶ Narration starts automatically as you approach a landmark
- ▶ Available in Hindi & English at launch
- ▶ 5 regional languages in Phase 2
- ▶ Local creator-recorded stories — not generic AI voice
- ▶ No competitor offers GPS-triggered narration in India at this resolution
- ▶ Play / Pause / Speed controls integrated with navigation
- ▶ Cached offline — works in low-signal zones

Scalable · Offline-Capable · India-Tuned

A three-tier mobile-first architecture engineered for 50K concurrent users at launch and 500K by end of Year 1.

CLIENT LAYER	SERVICE LAYER	DATA & EDGE LAYER
Mobile App (Android & iOS) Android 8+ · iOS 14+ · React Native / native modules	AI Recommendation Engine Plan generation, depth-level content selection, personalisation	Scalable Cloud · Auto-scaling 50K concurrent at launch → 500K by Year 1
SQLite Offline Cache 15 MB/locality · 5 cached cities · 24-hour expiry	Backend APIs (REST + WebSocket) Location, Content, Plan, Food, Group, Audio services	Content DB + CDN Guide content, audio MP3s, map tiles edge-cached
Google Maps SDK Tiles, directions, Places autocomplete	Real-Time Layer · Firebase Group sessions, polls, push notifications	DPDP-Compliant Storage Encrypted at rest & in transit · India-region hosted
SCALABILITY TARGET · 50,000 concurrent users at launch → 500,000 by Year 1 · 99.5% uptime · <2s home load · <3s plan generation		

Six Personas Across India's Travel Landscape

Acquisition prioritised by virality potential + LTV signals. All personas grounded in primary research and trip-frequency segmentation.

TIER 1 · LEAD College Travelers 18–24 · 3–4 trips/yr Motivations: Fun, freedom, Instagram moments, shared adventures Pain points: Budget overruns · one person stuck planning · expectation vs. reality	TIER 1 · LEAD Solo Travelers 24–34 · 2–3 trips/yr Motivations: Cultural immersion, off-beat experiences, freedom Pain points: Safety concerns · only visits popular spots · switching 4–6 apps	TIER 1 / 2 Budget Backpackers 18–28 · ₹800–2K/day Motivations: Adventure, authentic local-stay experiences Pain points: Connectivity fails when needed · no shared budget tracker
TIER 2 · GROWTH Weekend Explorers 27–45 · frequent 2–5 day breaks Motivations: Decompress, max-value short trips Pain points: Only 2–3 hrs free per stop · defaults to obvious places	TIER 2 Couple Travelers 25–38 · 2–4 trips/yr Motivations: Shared experiences, romance, local discovery Pain points: Breaking the moment to look up info kills the experience	TIER 3 · SCALE Pilgrims 45–70 · 1–3 trips/yr Motivations: Spiritual fulfilment, family rituals, festival travel Pain points: Darshan timings scattered · dress codes · no language support

Every Existing Solution Leaves the Same Gap

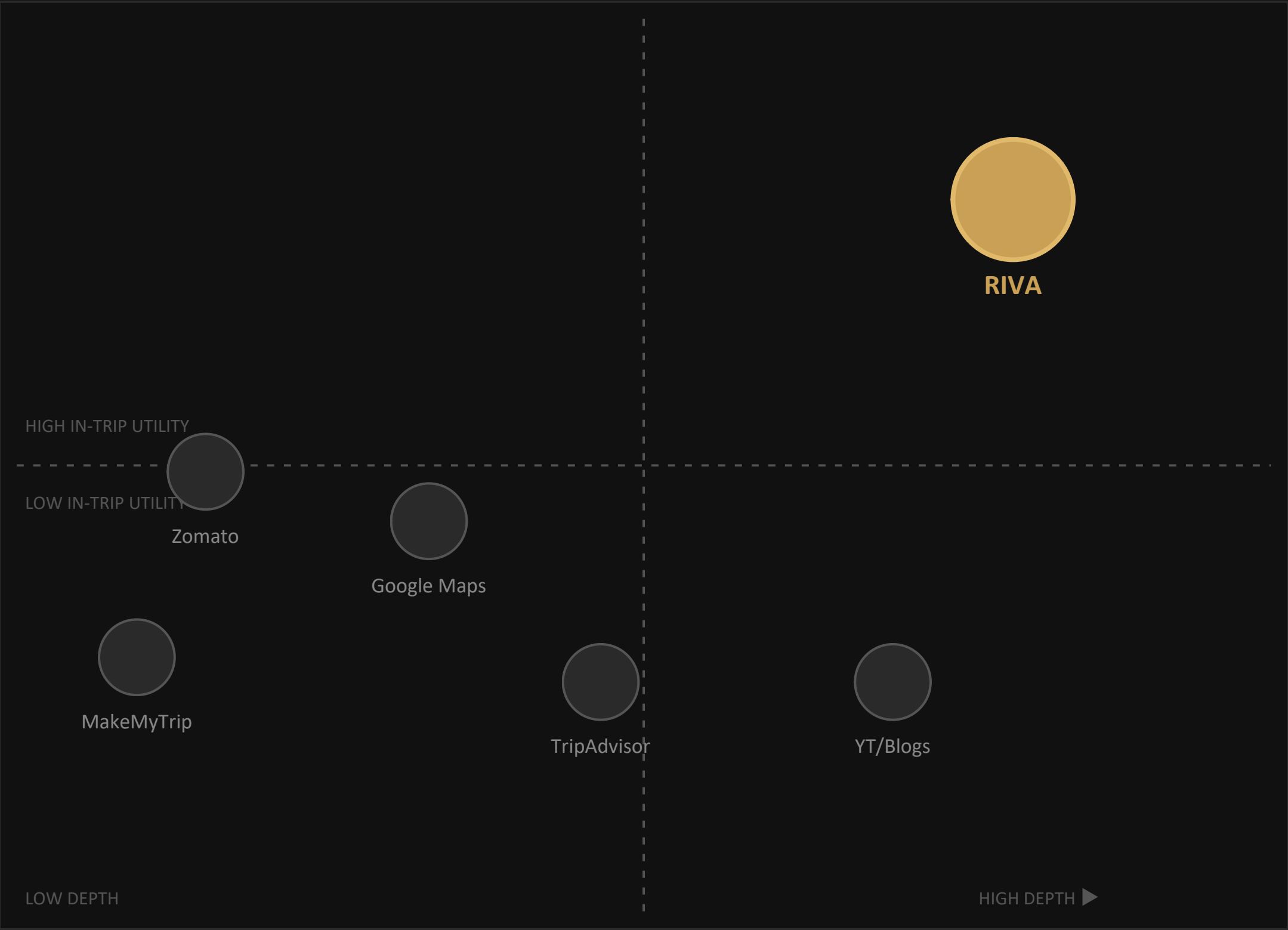
Each major incumbent solves one slice. None solves the in-trip, hyperlocal, India-native moment together.

Capability	G. Maps	TripAdvisor	Zomato	MakeMyTrip	YT / Blogs	RIVA
Hyperlocal recommendations	X	X	X	X	~	✓
Real-time contextual suggestions	~	X	X	X	X	✓
Offline-first experience	~	X	X	X	X	✓
AI personalization	X	X	X	X	X	✓
In-trip utility	~	~	~	X	~	✓
Local hidden gems	X	~	X	X	~	✓
Solo traveler safety	X	X	X	X	X	✓
Regional language support	~	X	~	~	X	✓

THE GAP RIVA FILLS · Real-time, hyperlocal, preference-aware context — delivered offline, in Indian languages, at the moment of need.

RIVA Owns the Upper-Right — By Design

X-axis: Depth of local context. Y-axis: In-trip utility. Only RIVA scores high on both.



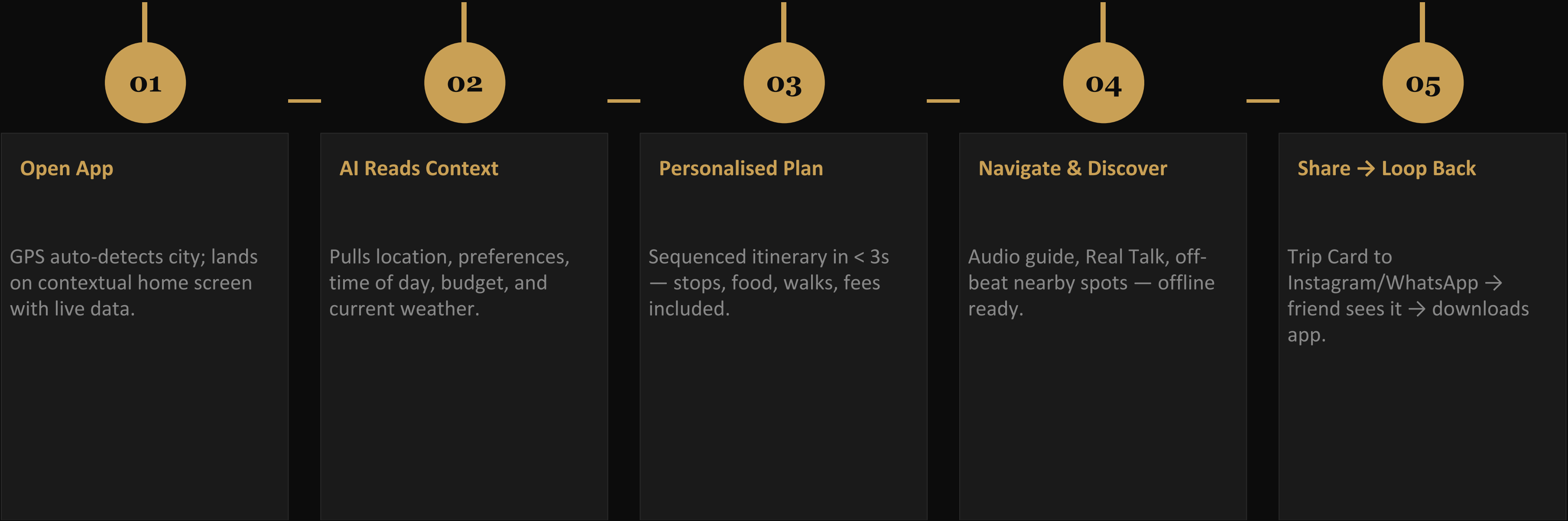
THE WHITESPACE RIVA OWNS

RIVA is the only product where utility AND depth coexist — a position no Indian travel app currently holds.

- ◆ Hyperlocal content at landmark level
- ◆ GPS-triggered audio guides in Indian languages
- ◆ Real Talk — honest, crowdsourced trust layer
- ◆ Pilgrimage module · 300M+ trips/yr · blue ocean
- ◆ India-native: UPI, offline, regional languages

From 'I Just Arrived' to 'I'm a Local' — in 30 Seconds

RIVA's workflow is engineered around peak intent moments. Each step delivers value before asking for sign-up.



↑ Each shared Trip Card returns new users into Step 01 — closing the acquisition loop · Target K-factor: 0.4

18-Month Phased Rollout — Earn Trust, Then Scale

Organic-first. Each phase has a single learning goal. We do not advance until prior phase success criteria are met.

PHASE 1	PHASE 2	PHASE 3	PHASE 4
Months 1–3 Foundation Founding 500 power users hand-picked. Closed beta · college community seeding · influencer brief programme begins. GOAL: Trust + product-market fit signals	Months 4–6 Beta City Launch Jaipur (culture + food) · Rishikesh/Haridwar (pilgrimage + adventure) · Coorg (offline & nature testing). GOAL: Validate 3 use-cases at city scale	Months 7–12 Community Scale Referral loops live · Trip Card K-factor 0.4 · Creator onboarding scaled to 50+ micro · WhatsApp city groups. GOAL: Sustainable organic acquisition	Months 13–18 Scale & Monetisation Tourism + hospitality partnerships · National scale · iOS full rollout · RIVA Pro ₹99/month launched. GOAL: Revenue + 25L MAU target

Organic-First Acquisition Strategy

Paid acquisition reserved for Phase 3 when unit economics are validated. Phase 1 & 2 rely entirely on content, community, and product-led virality.

40%	Content Marketing RIVA's primary acquisition engine and moat-builder. Every piece of content serves dual purpose: ranking for travel search intent AND building brand as India's most trustworthy travel source. Target: top 5 for 'India travel guide' by Week 2 of launch.
30%	Influencer & Creator Partnerships Three creator tiers: Mega (₹2–5L/collab) for awareness, Mid-tier (₹25–80K) for real app usage, Micro (₹30–50/install) for highest authenticity & conversion. Key principle: never pay for scripted promotion.
15%	Product-Led Virality Trip Card is the most powerful tool. Auto-generated at trip end: places visited, off-beat finds, km walked, money saved. Shared to Instagram Stories & WhatsApp with embedded 'Discover RIVA' CTA.
15%	Community Building WhatsApp City Guides (one per anchor city) · Reddit presence in r/IndiaTravel · Campus ambassador programme (1 per top 50 colleges) · Travel Facebook groups: value-first, not promotional.

Seven Mechanics · One Launch · Organic Ignition

RIVA's launch is organic-first. Paid acquisition is reserved for Phase 3 — only after unit economics are validated.

Pre-launch

Waitlist Campaign

10K pre-launch signups · RIVA.in landing page · curiosity-first copy. No screenshots.

Month 1–2

Founding 500

Hand-picked beta users · lifetime Pro access · daily WhatsApp feedback loops.

Ongoing

Reddit & Communities

r/IndiaTravel, r/solotravel · value-first answers · WhatsApp city groups. Not spammy.

Month 2–4

Influencer Seeding

50 micro + 10 mid creators · genuine app usage during real trips · no scripts policy.

Launch Day

Launch-Day Activation

7 AM Play Store live · staggered waitlist emails · 5 creators post simultaneously.

Month 4+

Referral Campaigns

Trip Card with embedded download QR · K-factor target 0.4 · 'Made with RIVA' footer.

Ongoing

Social Virality Loops

Plans share to WhatsApp · group invite triggers · social loop naturally closes.

Earn Trust First. Monetise from Phase 4.

Phase 1–3 is entirely free. Pricing introduced only when daily-active habit is proven. ₹99/month hits the Indian subscription sweet spot.

FREE ₹0 Forever free · Phase 1–3 ✓ Location detection + basic Explore ✓ Quick & Depth content levels ✓ Plan generation · 2 plans/day ✓ Smart Food Finder ✓ Offline mode · 1 locality cached	RECOMMENDED — RIVA PRO ₹99/mo Power user · monthly subscription ✓ Unlimited plan generation ✓ Full History depth · all audio guides ✓ Offline mode · 5 localities cached ✓ Pilgrimage module + Real Talk ✓ Group up to 10 · UPI split + journal ✓ Early access to new features	B2B & PARTNERSHIPS Phase 4+ Local Business Verified hotel & vendor premium placement Sponsored Discovery Tourism board content clearly labelled Creator Ecosystem Revenue share on creator-driven Pro signups Corporate Travel Desk Bulk Pro licences + reporting dashboard
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₹99/month sits above ₹29 (perceived cheap) and below ₹199 (too expensive for travel utility) — the Indian subscription sweet spot.

Compounding Loops — Not Campaigns

Three self-reinforcing growth loops that compound. Each produces a different moat: acquisition, content quality, and retention.

LOOP 01 · SHARE	LOOP 02 · CONTENT	LOOP 03 · GROUP
The Acquisition Loop K-factor: 0.4 Trip ends → Trip Card auto-generated → Shared to Instagram/WhatsApp → Friends download → Trip begins. Every share reaches ~200 connections on average. 1 Trip ends 2 Trip Card created 3 Social share 4 Friend downloads 5 New trip begins	The Moat Loop Compounding content Real Talk added → Content quality improves → Users trust app more → More users contribute. The moat compounds over time and is impossible to replicate quickly. 1 User contributes tip 2 Content quality up 3 Better discovery 4 More user visits 5 More contributions	The Retention Loop Natural K-factor trigger Group invited to trip → All download → Budget split + polls → Memorable trip → Next trip, same group defaults to RIVA automatically. 1 User invites group 2 All download RIVA 3 Budget split + polls 4 Memorable trip 5 Repeat use

From 0 to 100K Users in 12 Months

★ NORTH STAR METRIC: WEEKLY ACTIVE TRAVELLERS (WAT)

Users who generate a Plan OR activate Explore mode at least once in a 7-day window

100K

MAU by Month 12

1M

MAU by Month 18

>30%

D1 Retention target

>20%

D7 Retention target

>12%

D30 Retention target

NPS >45

At Launch

K-factor 0.4

Trip Card referral rate

<₹50

CAC per install

METRIC	RESPONSE IF BELOW TARGET
D1 Retention < 30%	Fix onboarding and first-session value delivery
D7 Retention < 20%	Fix push notification strategy and in-app content freshness
D30 Retention < 12%	Introduce between-trip engagement loop before scaling paid
Audio Guide Activation Low	Improve discoverability of audio guide entry point in UX

Product, Market & Revenue Milestones

M1–3 CLOSED BETA	M4–6 PUBLIC LAUNCH	M7–12 SCALE TO 50 CITIES	M13–18 RIVA PRO + B2B
3 anchor cities: Jaipur, Rishikesh, Coorg 500 founding power users from applications - Weekly NPS — target >45 before launch - Full guide coverage for 3 cities - Audio guide piloted at Amber Fort & Rishikesh ghats - Gate: Trip card share rate >20% before public launch	- Top 20 Indian cities live - App Store & Play Store full listing - Launch Day Activation playbook - Waitlist email batches · 5 creators post simultaneously - Press: YourStory, Inc42, Hindustan Times Travel - First monetisation signals tested	- Referral loops live · K-factor 0.4 - Group features: shared budgets, polls - WhatsApp city groups + campus ambassadors 200 indexed articles · 50 YouTube videos - Performance marketing initiated 100K MAU milestone target	- RIVA Pro launched at ₹99/month - National scale — 50+ cities covered - B2B: hotel chains, tourism boards, airlines - Corporate Travel Desk SaaS launched - Pilgrimage module fully deployed 1M MAU milestone target

Phase 1+2 Budget: ₹1.2–1.5 Crore (Months 1–12)

Budget Line	Amount	Notes
Content creation (blog, video, social)	₹15–20L	2 FTE + freelance writers & videographers
Influencer partnerships (micro + mid)	₹25–35L	50 micro + 5 mid-tier. Performance-based where possible
Community management + events	₹8–12L	WhatsApp moderation, campus stipends, 2 beta meetups
PR & media outreach	₹5–8L	PR agency retainer + launch. Target top 10 travel/tech pubs
ASO & store listing creative	₹3–5L	Keyword research, screenshot design, A/B testing
Analytics & attribution stack	₹4–6L	Firebase, AppsFlyer/Branch, Mixpanel
Contingency & experiments	₹10–15L	Small paid experiments, opportunistic partnerships

B U D G E T A L L O C A T I O N



Six Known Risks — Each with a Concrete Mitigation

Risk is acknowledged early. Each risk has a probability assessment and a pre-built response — not a vague plan.

MEDIUM

Retention Risk

RISK: D30 falls below 12% — travel apps face structural infrequency.

MITIGATION: Between-trip engagement loop · weekly 'Local Secret' for home city · delay scale until 25% D30.

MEDIUM

Fake Creator Content

RISK: Creators script sponsored content that feels inauthentic, eroding brand trust.

MITIGATION: Brief-first approach · kill any partnership within 48h of inauthenticity · affiliate-based payouts.

MEDIUM

Competitor Copying

RISK: Google or Zomato ship similar features with their distribution advantage.

MITIGATION: Moat = content depth + audio + pilgrimage + Real Talk community — none shippable in 3 months.

LOW · CRITICAL

Safety Incidents

RISK: A user-safety incident with the SOS or matching feature.

MITIGATION: Match feature deferred to Phase 3 with full ID verification + moderation + escalation built first.

MEDIUM

Scalability Challenges

RISK: Mid-range Android lag · plan-generation latency · 50K concurrent spikes.

MITIGATION: Mandatory testing on Redmi 10/Realme C · auto-scaling cloud · CDN at edge.

LOW · CRITICAL

App Store Dependency

RISK: Policy violation removes app from Play Store / App Store.

MITIGATION: Legal review of UGC policies pre-launch · no content bypasses moderation · dedicated compliance owner.

Ecosystem Partnerships — Expand Distribution

Each partner tier serves a different strategic purpose: data, discovery, or distribution at scale.

Data + Content State Tourism Boards Kerala, Rajasthan, Maharashtra, Uttarakhand — co-branded content, landmark data, official partnership credibility.	Distribution Travel Aggregators MakeMyTrip, Cleartrip, ixigo — deep-link from post-booking confirmation screen. Intercept user at highest intent moment.	Discovery Hospitality OYO, FabHotel, boutique hotels — in-room QR card: 'Your local guide is waiting'. Zero friction discovery moment.
Distribution Transportation IRCTC, IndiGo, Air India — post-booking trigger with destination-detected RIVA deeplink. Reach user before they arrive.	Acquisition Education College travel clubs, NSS, NCC — RIVA as official trip planning tool + campus ambassador programme.	Content + Acquisition Creator Ecosystem 50+ micro-creators on affiliate model. Revenue share on Pro signups. Authenticity-first brief — no scripted promotions.

RIVA



Making every Indian traveller feel like a local — anywhere.

— THE RIVA PRODUCT THESIS

2.3 BILLION TRIPS · 900M+ SMARTPHONES · ONE TRUSTED COMPANION

2.3B+

Domestic trips annually

\$16.4B

Online travel market

₹99/mo

Pro subscription

100K

MAU target · 12 months

● RIVA

THANK YOU